Eliott **THOMAS**

PhD Candidate in Document AI · Machine Learning Researcher



I work on reliable information extraction when labeled data is scarce. Final-year industrial (CIFRE) PhD between La Rochelle University (L3i) and Yooz, with 7 papers at WACV & ICDAR and methods running in production. Defending 16 December 2026, and looking for an applied-research role in an organisation whose mission I believe in.

eliott.thomas99@protonmail.com · +33 6 85 40 42 55
github.com/eliottthomas99 · linkedin.com/in/eliott-thomas-a7b420193
La Rochelle, France · open to relocation in Europe · hybrid or on-site preferred
French citizen · Available from January 2027

EXPERIENCE

Research Engineer, CIFRE PhD — Jan 2024 – Present
Yooz · L3i Lab (La Rochelle University), France

- Research on table extraction under scarce supervision at Yooz, an AP-automation SaaS company (600+ employees). 5 first-author papers accepted at WACV & ICDAR (2025–2026).
- Moved research into Yooz's production pipeline, now extracting data from customer business documents at scale.
- Training and evaluation: fine-tuned SmolDocling with QLoRA, trained DETR, D-FINE and YOLO detectors, designed a new training loss (ConRTF), and benchmarked commercial vision-language models with an automated error taxonomy and a measured 10^4 emissions gap (WACV 2026).
- Data: built a quality model to select pseudo-labels (QUEST) and adapted active learning to a two-stage pipeline with per-task uncertainty calibration (ICDAR 2026).
- Supervision: 5 research interns (3 at Yooz, 2 at L3i).

Research Engineer, Labcom IDEAS — Jan – Dec 2023
L3i Lab, La Rochelle University, France

- Information extraction from administrative and business documents. Co-authored 2 ICDAR 2023 papers on key–value pair extraction and subgraph-induced extraction.

Final-Year Project: NLP for Crisis Response — May – Dec 2022
LITIS Lab, Rouen, France

- Fine-tuned French BERT-family models for multi-label classification of tweets posted after industrial disasters, on a corpus annotated by the team.

Teaching: Machine Learning & CS — 2023 – Present
EIGSI & La Rochelle University, France

- Machine Learning (M2) · Introduction to Web (L2) · Computer Science (L1).

Reviewer: ICDAR — 2024 – 2026

- ICDAR 2026 main conference and DAS workshop · ICDAR 2024 VisionDocs workshop.

EDUCATION

PhD in Artificial Intelligence (CIFRE) — 2024 – 2026
La Rochelle University · L3i Lab, France

- Reliable table extraction in business documents under limited labeled data. Defense: 16 December 2026.

Engineering Degree in CS + M.Sc. Data & AI — 2019 – 2022
ENSSAT Lannion, France · Université de Sherbrooke, Canada

- Dual-degree programme, with the final year in Canada specialising in machine learning and data science.

Classe Préparatoire (Maths Spé) — 2017 – 2019
Lycée Dupuy de Lôme, Lorient, France

PUBLICATIONS

- **ICDAR 2026** Active Learning for Cascaded Object Detection: Balancing Coverage and Uncertainty in Table Extraction Pipelines
- **ICDAR 2026** ConRTF: Edge-Constrained Boundary Distribution Refinement for Real-time Transformer Table Structure Recognition
- **WACV 2026** Zero-Shot Table Extraction in Business Documents: A Unified Benchmark with Error Taxonomy and Ecological Analysis
- **ICDAR 2025** QUEST: Quality-aware Semi-supervised Table Extraction for Business Documents
- **WACV 2025** RAPTOR: Refined Approach for Product Table Object Recognition
- **ICDAR 2023** SETI: Subgraph-Induced Extraction Technique for Information from Administrative Documents
- **ICDAR 2023** Extracting Key-Value Pairs in Business Documents

SKILLS

Machine Learning

PyTorch · Hugging Face Transformers · computer vision (object detection, table structure recognition) · NLP · LLMs & vision-language models (VLMs) · zero-shot inference · semi-supervised & active learning · uncertainty estimation & prediction confidence · fine-tuning · scikit-learn

Engineering

Python · SQL · R · Docker · Git · Linux · GPU server administration · SLURM · LaTeX

LANGUAGES

French	Native
English	Professional fluency (C1)
Spanish	Intermediate (B1)

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY

- Vice-President then Treasurer, ADocs (2024–2025), the doctoral students' association (100 members), where I managed the budget.
- Founded the PhD Club at L3i, a weekly meet-up where a student presents anything useful to fellow PhDs (outside their own research topic).
- Administrator of the team's shared GPU server (NVIDIA A6000), L3i Lab (2023–present).
- Member, University Research Commission, La Rochelle University (2025–present).
- Treasurer, TSEL student sports tournament (2020–2021).

INTERESTS

Running · Video games · Fitness · Badminton · Cinema